I dine with the Ambassador[41] occasionally, and his parties are very entertaining from the mixture of people of different nations attached to the mission. There are but two Russians amongst them, but then there are Poles, Germans, Georgians, Circassians, Turks and Armenians. His Exclly himself is a Sclavonian formerly a soldier of fortune in Napoleons army invading Russia; was taken prisoner by the Russians, and after the French had retired, he took service with his captors, receiving the same rank which he had held in the French army. Since then he has been serving almost entirely in Georgia and against the Turks and Persians; it is curious to hear six languages talked in the same room by different people, but this is frequently the case here. I myself can only manage French and Turkish. I *understand* some Persian and can talk a little but as all the people of this place talk Turkish, I have not much occasion for it.

I have received your letter of Octr 19th and in it you say that you wish me to come to meet Charles at Trebizonde, Charles in his former letter expressed the same wish in these words, "if you have nothing to do you had better take a trip to meet me" — had he said that it was perfectly necessary I should undoubtedly have come, but he did not mention it as on business, at all, I therefore regarded it as so much time lost, because while I am remaining here I am always gaining information about business, and for the last six months have been earning money, by selling goods on commission.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO HIS PARENTS] *Tabreez, August 15th, 1833*

Most sincerely my Dear Father and Mother do I ask your pardon for the neglect with which I have treated you during the last four months, the only excuse I have is that whenever a tartar has been about to start I have been as busy as we used to be at Leeds on "packing days." I should think that before this time Mr. Beek will have arrived in England, and have called on you, should he do so I have no doubt that your penetration will soon discover that all he says with regard to Persia does not deserve implicit credence; although Mr. B. and I were on very fair terms whilst he was in this country he has not left very favourable impressions either upon my mind or upon the minds of any body else here or at Constantinople, he is just the sort of man is every body's acquaintance and nobody's friend. I should say just the contrary of Bonham. Should you happen to meet a Mr. Paxton[42] in England (Lieutenant 4th Lt. Dragoons) please remember me to him. He staid about 10 days at my house as he was passing thro' Tabreez; he was going home on leave for three years from India, if you should like to see him you will hear of him at the cavalry depôt Maidstone.

[41] Count Simonich.

[42] James Llewellyn Paxton, according to the British Army List for 1833.

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